T3KJ

Manual: loading tones, the block card, scenes and footswitches, presets, MIDI with the Quad Cortex, and automating in REAPER.



T3KJ is Jon's build of the free, open-source TONE3000 plugin: NAM captures and impulse responses in a signal chain, plus My Gear, scenes, footswitches, a split channel strip, skins and cover art.

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1 Start here

T3KJ loads **NAM captures** (amps, pedals, full rigs) and **IRs** (cabinets, rooms) as blocks in a signal chain. A NAM capture is a snapshot of real gear at the knob settings it was captured with: to change the amp's knobs, load another capture (a "tone" can hold several, one per setting) or shape it with the block EQ and the faceplate.

1. Run **T3KJ-v...-windows-x64.exe**: standalone app, VST3 and CLAP. It installs next to the official TONE3000 plugin without touching it. Windows may warn the first time: *More info → Run anyway*.
2. **REAPER:** *Options → Preferences → Plug-ins → VST → Re-scan*, then add **T3KJ** to your guitar track, after dJONt if you use it.
3. **Standalone:** open T3KJ from the Start menu, then ☰ → **Settings** for your audio interface (ASIO for the lowest latency), inputs, outputs and MIDI inputs.
4. Click **+** in the chain to load a tone, or drag a `.nam` / `.wav` file (or a folder) onto it.

> **Hover anything.** The bar at the bottom explains every control as you point at it (turn it back on in Settings if you hid it). Most controls also have a right-click (advanced decks, menus).

What T3KJ adds to the stock TONE3000 plugin

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES
My Gear	Your own captures and IRs from a folder on your computer, with Recent and Pinned, shown before the TONE3000 search (section 3).
Scenes	Up to eight versions of the preset (A to H): which blocks are on, their levels and EQ, and the faceplate (section 8).
Footswitches	Group blocks on switches 1 to 8 that turn them on and off together (section 8).
Split strip	With two chains, lane 2 gets its own Input, Gate, tone stack and Output (section 6).
Skins, art, notes	Seven looks, your own cover art for local tones, block labels, and notes per tone (section 11).
Scene parameter	REAPER can automate scene changes from the timeline (section 10).

T3KJ updates itself with TONE3000's changes every night, so new features from the official plugin arrive here too.

2 The screen at a glance



1 **Preset bar:** ‹ › step through presets; click the name to browse, rename, reorder (section 7).

2 **Save** (disk) and **New** (+). New clears the chain and resets every control.

3 **Mono / Stereo:** one chain, or independent Left and Right chains (section 6).

4 **Tuner.** Click again to go back.

5 **Undo / Redo** for chain edits (loads, moves, settings, scenes added or deleted).

6 **Menu:** Settings, **Manual** (this PDF), and TONE3000 sign-in / sign-out.

7 **Blocks:** click one to open its card (section 4); drag to reorder, Alt-drag to duplicate, right-click for the tile menu.

8 **+ slot:** add a tone here, or drop files on it.

9 **Footswitch badge:** the block is on switch 1 to 8 (section 8).

10 **Scenes** A to H and **+** (section 8).

11 **Footswitch chips:** one per switch in use; click to stomp it.

12 **Meters:** input on the left, output on the right; the dot at the top latches red on clipping (click to clear).

13 **Input** level (and the input-mode menu on a stereo input).

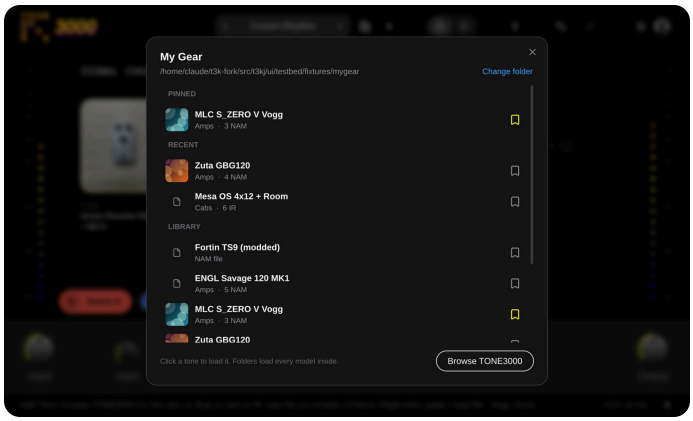
14 **Gate** (right-click for Release / Hold / Range). Pitch Shift sits next to it when shown.

15 **Bass / Middle / Treble:** the global tone stack, with its power switch.

16 **Spread:** mono-to-stereo double (Align in stereo mode).

17 **Output** level.

3 Loading tones



My Gear: Pinned, Recent and your Library. Browse TONE3000 is at the bottom.



Right-click a block: Copy, Load File, Load Folder, Footswitch (Set Art for local tones).

My Gear (your own files)

Click **+** (or a block's swap button) and My Gear opens first. **Change folder** points it at the folder where you keep captures (subfolders included, three levels deep). Every folder that holds `.nam` or IR `.wav` files shows up as one tone with all its models; loose files show on their own. **Pin** favourites with the bookmark; **Recent** fills itself. **Browse TONE3000** switches to the online search. (Settings → *Open My Gear First* turns this off.)

TONE3000 (online)

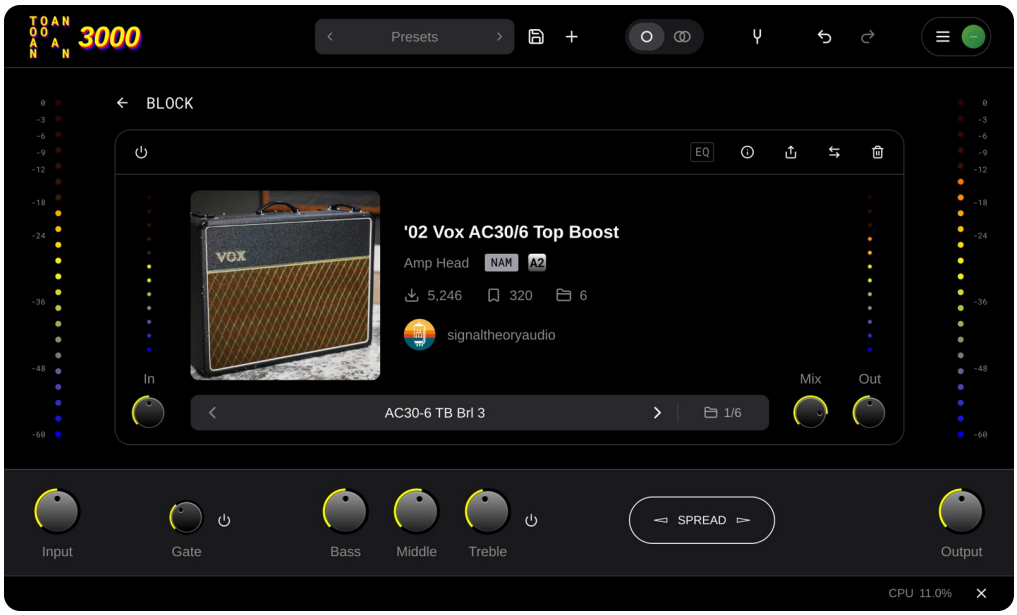
Sign in once (☰ → Login: a browser page, or a code on your phone). Search by title, gear, tags or creator; filter by gear type, format (NAM / IR), makes, creators, verified creators or calibrated; or open your Profile for Recently used, Favorites and your own uploads. Pick a tone and it lands in the slot.

Files and folders

Drag a `.nam` (A2), an IR `.wav`, or a folder of them onto a **+** slot, or right-click → *Load File* / *Load Folder*. No account needed. A folder becomes one block with every model inside it.

DO THIS	TO
Click a block	Open its card (levels, EQ, model).
Drag a block	Move it in the chain. Alt-drag duplicates it.
Right-click → Copy, then right-click a + → Paste	A copy with every setting.
Swap (in the card)	Replace the tone, keep the slot.
Right-click → Set Art	Your own JPG / PNG as the tile's art (local tones; saved next to the files).

4 The block card



A capture's card: the model picker (‹ AC30-6 TB Brl 3 › and 1/6) switches between the models in this tone.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Power	Bypass this block (top left of the card, or a footswitch / scene).
In / Out	Level into and out of the block, ±24 dB. Out comes after the Mix, so it moves the whole blend.
Mix	Dry against wet: lower blends the block's input back in (handy on IRs and reverb-like captures).
Model picker	‹ › steps through the captures in this tone (each is the gear at different settings); the folder icon lists them.
EQ	A 6-band EQ on the wet signal. **PRE** puts it before the capture (changes how it distorts), off = after. **Sliders** view for gains, **Curve** view to drag bands (scroll = width, Alt-click = reset). An outlined EQ button means it's shaping the sound.
Info (i)	The tone's description, makes and tags, plus your own label and notes (local tones keep them in a `tk3j.json` beside the files).
Normalize	Levels the block's loudness so captures sit at a similar volume (Settings → Per-Block Normalization shows it).
NAM size	LITE saves CPU, FULL is the most accurate (Settings → Per-Block NAM Size shows it).

Calibration: captures made with calibration data set their own input level from your interface's dBu (Settings → Calibration). Uncalibrated ones use Normalize instead. If you're not sure, leave both at their defaults.

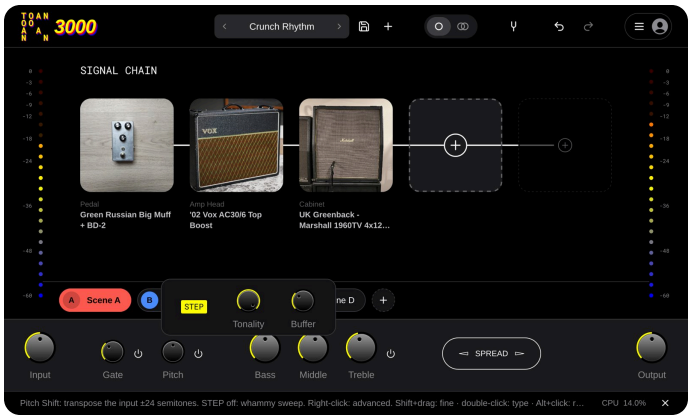
5 The faceplate

The bottom row works on the whole chain. Its knobs (all but Pitch) are also part of each scene (section 8).

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Input	Level into the chain. With a stereo input, its menu picks how the two channels enter: Stereo SUM, Stereo (channel 1 → Left chain, 2 → Right), Dual Mono (L and R each run the chain; twice the CPU), Left or Right only.
Gate	Noise gate threshold (−100 to 0 dB) and power. **Right-click** for Release (5–500 ms), Hold (0–200 ms) and Range (20–80 dB; 80 = full mute).
Pitch Shift	Transposes the DI before the amp, ±24 semitones: −2 plays drop D on a standard-tuned guitar. Off by default and hidden until Settings → *Show Pitch Shift*. On adds latency (11–31 ms, reported to REAPER). **Right-click:** STEP (whole semitones; off = smooth whammy sweep), Tonality (highs above it stay unshifted, keeps the pick natural), Buffer (shorter = less latency, longer = cleaner lows). Pitch is **not** per scene.
Bass / Middle / Treble	Global tone stack after the chain: ±20 dB at 150 Hz, ±15 dB at 425 Hz, ±10 dB at 1.8 kHz; 5 = flat. Its power switch bypasses it.
Spread	Mono chain only: turns it into a wide double-tracked stereo sound with a short, wobbling delay on one side. Right-click for Wobble, Crossover (keeps the lows mono) and Diffuse. The mono-safety light warns if it would cancel on a mono sum.
Output	Master level, ±24 dB.



Gate's advanced deck (right-click the Gate).



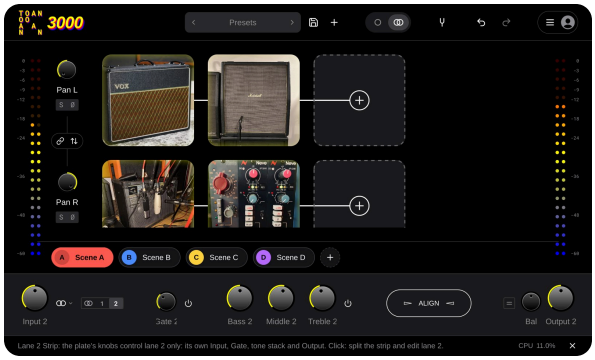
Pitch Shift's deck: STEP, Tonality, Buffer.

6 Stereo, two chains and the split strip



Stereo mode with the Right chain branching off the Left one after the amp.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Stereo	The header switch: a Left and a Right chain, each with its own blocks. Mono runs only the Left chain to both outputs.
Branch	Click the gap after a block: the other chain starts from that point (one amp into two cabs, say). Click the branch point to make the chains independent again.
Pan L / R, Link	Where each chain sits; Link mirrors them.
Solo, Ø	Hear one chain alone; flip a chain's polarity if the two sound hollow together.
Balance, Auto	Trims the chains against each other (±12 dB). Auto: play for about 2 s and it matches their levels.
Align, Auto	Delays one chain up to 24 ms when captures carry different latency. Auto runs a half-second sweep and also fixes flipped polarity.
Swap	Exchange the Left and Right chains.
Split strip	With two lanes running (stereo or dual mono), the lane buttons split the faceplate: lane 2 gets its own Input, Gate, tone stack and Output. Click lane 1 / lane 2 to choose which one the knobs edit.



7 Presets

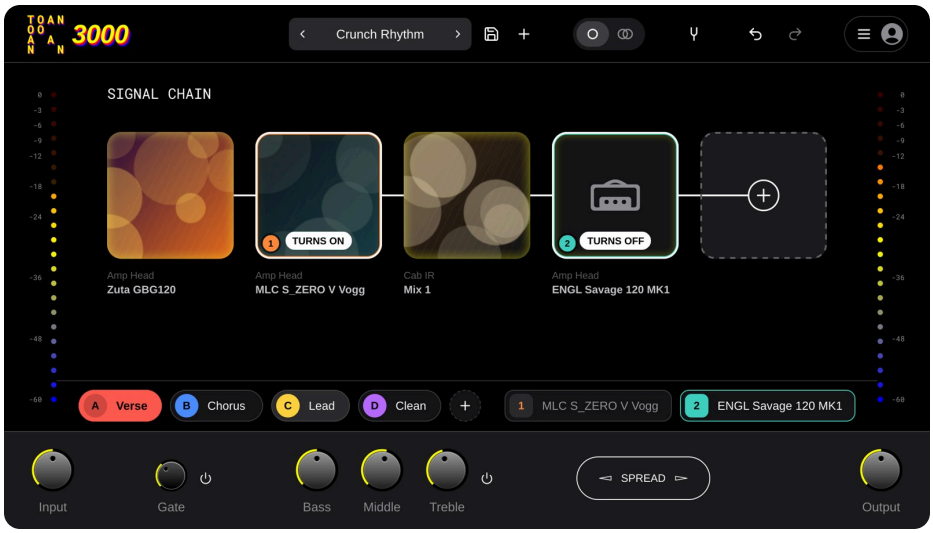


A preset is the whole chain (every block, its model and settings, with the captures embedded so it loads offline), the faceplate, and **all of its scenes**. It leaves out what belongs to your rig: calibration, oversampling, solo, input mode, the MIDI map and the window size.

TO	DO THIS
Save	Disk icon, type a name. The same name overwrites: that's how you edit a preset.
Start from scratch	**+** (New) clears the chain and resets every control. Save first if you want to keep what you had.
Browse / rename / delete	Click the preset name.
Reorder	Drag presets in the browser. Prev / Next and MIDI follow the order.
See PC numbers	Turn on *MIDI PC* in the browser: each preset shows the Program Change that loads it.

Presets are plain files: Settings → Presets → *Open presets folder*. Copy them to back up or move to another computer.

8 Scenes and footswitches

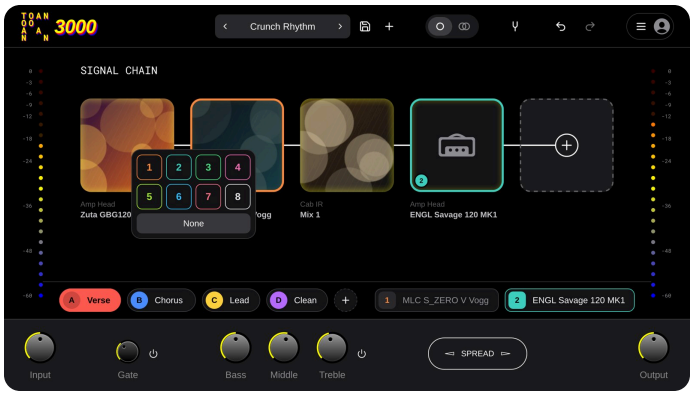


Hovering a scene marks the blocks it would turn on or off.

A **scene** is a version of the preset: for every block its power, In, Out, Mix and EQ, plus the faceplate (Input, Gate, Bass / Middle / Treble, Spread, Output, Balance). **Not** in scenes: Pitch (tuning stays put) and which capture a block has loaded (load the amps you want as separate blocks and turn them on per scene, like the "Amp Testing" setup). There's no save step: whatever you change in a scene is what that scene keeps, and scenes save with the preset.

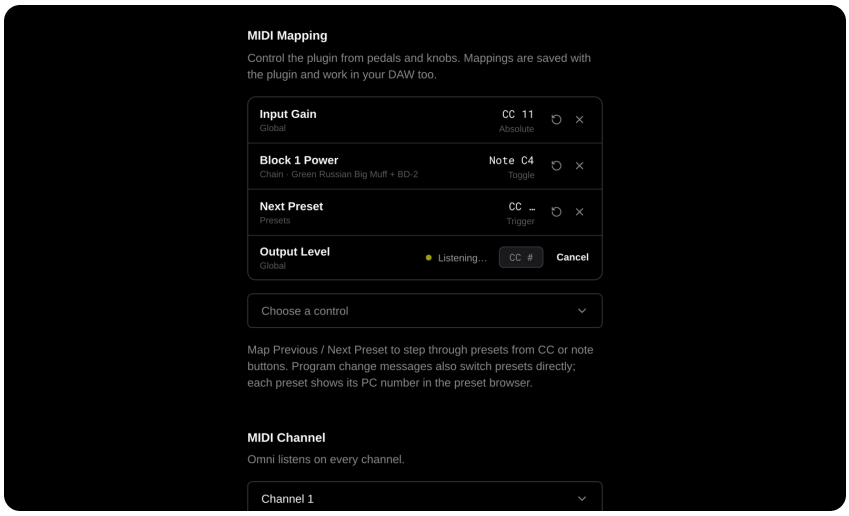
TO	DO THIS
Switch	Click a scene. Switching is instant: no capture reloads.
Add	**+** after the last scene, up to 8 (A to H). It starts as a copy of the one you're in.
Name	Double-click it (or right-click → Rename).
Delete	Right-click → Delete. Later scenes move up a letter. Undo brings it back.

Footswitches 1 to 8



Right-click a block → *Footswitch…* and pick 1 to 8. Every block on the same switch turns on and off together, and the switch shows as a chip next to the scenes (click it to stomp). Use footswitches for things you kick in during a scene (a boost, a delay); use scenes for whole changes.

9 MIDI and the Quad Cortex



☰ → **Settings** → **MIDI Mapping:** *Choose a control*, then move the knob / press the switch on your controller (or type its CC). Mappings save with the plugin and in your REAPER project. In the standalone app, tick your controller under MIDI inputs first.

TARGET	HOW IT RESPONDS
Program Change	No mapping needed: PC n loads the preset at position n in the list (PC 0 = the first).
Scene (value 0–7 = A–H)	The CC's **value** picks the scene: 0 = A, 1 = B… Values past the last scene are ignored. Reliable for automation: the value always says which scene.
Footswitch 1–8	Each press flips the switch (on ↔ off). A momentary QC switch (127 then 0) flips once per stomp.
Block N Power	Flips that block on / off per press.
Knobs and power switches	Follow the CC value (an expression pedal on Pitch makes a whammy).
Previous / Next Preset	Step through the list.

> **One footswitch, three devices.** On the Quad Cortex, changing presets sends a Program Change: T3KJ and dJONt each load their preset at that number, so keep presets **in the same order** in both. For scenes, have the QC send **one CC** with values 0, 1, 2… and map that CC to *Scene* in T3KJ and to the scene switch in dJONt: one press switches all three.

10 Automating in REAPER

Faceplate controls and the **Scene** parameter are REAPER parameters, so they can be drawn as envelopes, no MIDI needed. Blocks themselves aren't parameters (the chain changes from preset to preset), so to turn blocks on and off over a song, **put them in scenes and automate the scene**.

A scene per section (envelope)

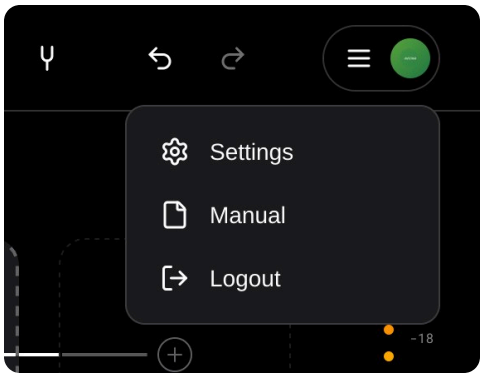
1. Set up the scenes: A verse, B chorus, C lead, and so on.
2. In REAPER's FX window for T3KJ: **Param → Show track envelope → Scene**. (For a faceplate knob, touch it in T3KJ first, then *Param → Show track envelope* picks the last touched control.)
3. Set the envelope points to **square** so it jumps instead of sliding, and draw the steps: each step is a scene (A at the bottom, H at the top).
4. Leave the track in *Read* mode. Clicking a scene while playing back follows the envelope again at the next point.

With MIDI instead

1. Settings → MIDI Mapping → *Scene (value 0–7 = A–H)*, then send the CC once (e.g. CC 20).
2. Put an empty MIDI item on the same track over the song, open it, add a **CC 20** lane and draw one event per section: value **0** = A, **1** = B, **2** = C...
3. dJONt before T3KJ passes the MIDI on, so the same item can switch dJONt's scenes too (map the same CC there).

Why not automate block power over MIDI? Block power and footswitch targets *flip* on each press, so automation gets out of step if a press is missed or you start playback mid-song. Scene values can't get out of step.

11 Settings, the tuner, and where things live



SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Show Info Bar	The hint bar at the bottom.
Show Gate / Pitch Shift	Which effects the faceplate shows (one that's switched on always shows).
Fit Chain to Window, Show Block Labels	Chain layout and the gear / name labels under each tile.
Show Scene Bar, Open My Gear First	The scene row; My Gear before the TONE3000 search.
Skin	Stock, Zenith, Tidal, Inferno, Ironwave, Hologram, Gilded. The look only: sound and presets don't change.
NAM A2 Size	A2-Lite (less CPU, sounds great) or A2-Full (most accurate) for new blocks; Per-Block NAM Size shows the switch on each card.
Calibration	Your interface's input level (dBu) for calibrated captures.
Oversampling	Runs the chain at 2×, 4× or 8× to cut aliasing (smoother highs on high gain). No added latency; more CPU.
Multi-Core Processing	Spreads the chains across CPU cores. Same sound either way.
Presets, Diagnostics	Open the presets folder; copy logs for a bug report.



Tuner: the fork icon in the header. Play one open string; click again to go back.

Where things live: presets, settings and UI preferences in `%APPDATA%\TONE3000` (shared with the official plugin); My Gear, scene-bar and skin choices per computer; cover art and notes for local tones next to their files (`tk3j.json`); this manual in `C:\Program Files\T3KJ\docs` .

12 Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	TRY THIS
REAPER doesn't list T3KJ, or lists TK3J	Re-scan VST3. TK3J was the old name; the installer removes it. Use T3KJ (the "T3 over knobs" icon).
No sound in the standalone app	☰ → Settings: input device and channels, outputs, and turn off the input mute (the banner says when it's muted).
A scene switch doesn't change something	Pitch and the loaded captures aren't part of scenes. For a different amp per scene, load each amp as its own block and turn them on per scene.
The QC loads the wrong preset	PC n = the nth preset in the browser's order (turn on *MIDI PC* to see the numbers). Match the order in dJONt.
A footswitch is "backwards"	Footswitch and block power targets flip per press; stomp it once to resync, or use scenes for anything that must be exact.
Crackles / high CPU	Bigger buffer, A2-Lite, oversampling off, Multi-Core on. Dual Mono doubles the amp CPU.
Everything feels late	Pitch Shift adds latency while it's on; turn it off or shorten its Buffer.
Two chains sound thin together	Flip one chain's Ø, or use Auto Align.
Something else	Settings → Diagnostics → Copy Logs, and paste them to Claude.